Want to study Data Science in the UK? Here are 3 things to know

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Data science has emerged to be one of the most popular subjects in the last decade that encompasses the theoretical and practical application of ideas. It's at the peak of evolution in a field of technology that's rapidly transforming the way we work and live.

With the rapid progression and advancements in technology, data science is here to stay and dominate the modern era. That is why, being a data scientist becomes an exciting career, where learning never stops.

Why studying data science is a good idea

Data scientists are highly educated 88% have at least a master's degree and 46% have PhDs and while there are eminent exceptions you will typically need a mathematical, engineering, computer science or scientific-related degree to get a place on a postgraduate course.

A degree in any of these courses will give you the skills you need to process and analyze any form of data. Of course, due to the level of interest many universities are now offering dedicated undergraduate courses in data science and analytics too.

With a basic understanding of data science, here's what you need to know before studying data science in the UK:

1. Work on improving special skills

Having a degree is not always enough, most data scientists also undertake online training to learn a special skill such as deploying machine learning models to the cloud or learning new methods for improving the performance of computer vision-based predictive models.

Apart from classroom learning, you can participate in Kaggle or CodaLab, which are examples of an online community of data scientists and machine learning practitioners that enable you to learn more by competing.

The skills you have learned during your degree programme, and outside your studies, will enable you to easily transition to data science at postgraduate level.

Look at whether the university you are considering offers further support.

For example, additional introductory courses which will allow you to enhance your data science knowledge or prepare you if you do not have a background in computer science.

2. Try numerous programming language techniques

Firstly, try to learn at least one programming language such as Python/R. Secondly, take free YouTube course on scientific writing.

Thirdly, try to build your smart working approach so you are using your time and energy as effectively as possible.

When you arrive at university, you will be given support in relation to independent study skills, but this will get your studies off to a flying start.

3. Do market research exclusively

Do your market research into jobs you are interested in. Filter out a few job packs from job sites and find out the key skills required in the market and start working on developing those skills and choosing modules that develop them.

The demand for data science professionals has grown remarkably owing to the urgent need for informed decision-making tailored for making effective strategies.

Organisations are looking to create a skilled talent pool that can provide technical expertise and move faster in the competitive environment.

Various specialisations within data science will define your responsibilities, what your work will involve and how you will progress in your field. Each one has its demands, training, and qualifications to keep in mind.

Data science job roles and employment

The big three roles within data science are Data Analyst, Data Scientist, and Data Engineer. There are also a variety of other job titles - such as Machine Learning Engineer, Quantitative Analyst, Data Warehouse Architect, Business Analyst, and Statistician.

If you are interested in those jobs, do some proper research into the skills and knowledge they require.

Data science graduates are getting hired by many companies around the globe. Universities also offer additional employment opportunities.

- Article by Dr Haider Raza, Lecturer, School of Computer Science and Electronics Engineering, University of Essex.

Read: Skills and online courses to become a Data Scientist, the top job role in the world by 2025

Read: Over 93,500 data science jobs vacant in India: Study

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